

Study Questions: Planning — Organizing a Crochet-Along

1. Explain **expected free energy** in the context of choosing a group crochet project. What are the epistemic and pragmatic components, and how do they trade off?
2. Compare three hypothetical project options (simple, moderate, complex) for your circle. Evaluate each in terms of expected free energy. Which would you recommend, and why?
3. Why might different circle members evaluate the expected free energy of the same project differently? How do individual generative models shape preferences?
4. Describe the concept of a **policy** in temporal planning. How does a crochet-along schedule function as a predicted trajectory of actions over time?
5. How does the circle handle **prediction under uncertainty** when planning a multi-week project? What tools (buffers, checkpoints, flexibility) help manage the unknown?
6. When the planned schedule for a crochet-along does not match reality (members fall behind, unexpected difficulties arise), what does the circle do? How does this relate to policy updating in Active Inference?
7. Describe a **skill-building progression** for a circle — a sequence of group projects designed to expand the collective generative model over time. What makes a good progression?
8. Why should each project in a skill-building progression sit in the group's **zone of proximal development**? What happens if a project is too easy or too hard?
9. How does planning a craft fair or charity drive integrate **all** the Active Inference concepts explored in this course (systems, agents, perception, cognition, action, learning, communication)?

10. Describe the role of **perception** during the execution of a group plan. How do circle members monitor each other's progress and adjust their own actions accordingly?
11. What does it mean for a plan to be a **living document** — continuously revised through active inference rather than fixed in advance?
12. How does the circle's **collective cognition** contribute to the planning process? What can the group plan together that no individual could plan alone?
13. When a planned crochet-along fails (half the members drop out, the pattern is too hard), what **prediction errors** does the circle experience? How do these errors improve future planning?
14. Explain how **communication** across multiple channels (in-person discussion, group chat, written plans) supports the planning and execution of a group project.
15. A circle decides between a project everyone knows (low uncertainty) and one that requires new skills (high uncertainty). Frame this choice in terms of **epistemic versus pragmatic value**.
16. How does the **diversity of agents** in the circle affect planning? What must the plan account for when members have very different skill levels and paces?
17. Planning a crochet-along requires **temporal coordination** — breaking a project into stages and setting a pace. Why is this harder than planning a single-session activity?
18. How does planning for a **public event** (craft fair, crochet-in-public day) extend the circle's Markov blanket? What new external states does the group encounter?
19. Describe how a crochet circle that has planned and executed several projects together differs from one that has never done group planning. What has the experienced circle's generative model gained?
20. Reflect on the full arc of this course — from systems to planning. How does each module build on the previous ones? Why is planning a fitting culmination of the Active Inference framework applied to crochet circles?